

JOLAN GOVENDER

*Actuarial Science
Honours Student*

CONTACT

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Location:
Johannesburg, South Africa

TECHNICAL & ANALYTICAL SKILLS

- RStudio (*Advanced*)
- Microsoft Excel (*Advanced*)
- Python (*Intermediate*)
- Actuarial Modelling
- Financial Mathematics
- Risk Theory & Reserving
- Life Contingencies
- Machine Learning & Neural Networks

LANGUAGES

- English – Native
- Afrikaans – Working
- Turkish – Elementary

INTERESTS

- Golf
- Padel
- Weight-lifting
- Financial Markets
- Economic History
- Chess

AWARDS

Bronze Medal
*International Environmental
Project Olympiad
Thermoelectric Generation,
2019*

Good Fellowship Award
Star College Boys High, 2022

◆ ABOUT ME

Currently completing my BScHons in Actuarial Science at the University of the Witwatersrand. My academic foundation in risk modelling and mathematical analysis is complemented by a genuine curiosity about the economic history and market forces that shape our world. I thrive when translating complex technical results into meaningful narratives, a skill I refine daily as a tutor for second-year students.

I enjoy using Artificial Intelligence (AI) to leverage my research, analyses and day-to-day workflows. I love finding structure in creativity. This makes me a versatile asset to a dynamic team, ready to contribute to high-impact projects and to grow professionally.

Outside the lecture hall, I maintain a high-performance mindset through weight-lifting and golf, believing that physical discipline is the cornerstone of mental clarity and professional excellence.

◆ ASSA EXEMPTIONS

8 exemptions earned through undergraduate study (2023–2025):

- **A112 (Business Economics)**
- **A113 (Business Finance)**
- **A211 (Financial Mathematics)**
- **A212 (Risk Modelling & Survival Analysis)**
- **A213 (Contingencies)**
- **A214 (Actuarial Economic Modelling)**
- **N111 (Foundation Actuarial Professional Practice)**
- **N211 (Communications)**

◆ EDUCATION

University of the Witwatersrand

2023 – Present

- **BScHons - Actuarial Science (2026-Present):**
 - Actuarial Risk Management (A311)
 - Anticipated F100s: F102 (Life Insurance) & F108 (Health, Social & Employee Benefits)
- **BSc - Actuarial Science & Mathematical Statistics (2023–2025)**

Star College Boys High School, Durban

2018 – 2022

- National Senior Certificate
- 7 Distinctions
- 88% Average

◆ RESEARCH

Mortality Forecasting Using Recurrent Neural Networks

2026 – Present

BScHons Research Project · University of the Witwatersrand

- Developing and validating predictive mortality forecasting frameworks utilising Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) and Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU) recurrent neural networks, benchmarking performance directly against classical actuarial models.
- This project has applications in the life assurance and pensions atmosphere.

◆ EMPLOYMENT

Tutor — Actuarial Science (2nd Year)

2026 – Present

University of the Witwatersrand

- Support 120+ second-year students across Financial Mathematics, Business Applications and Life Contingencies

◆ REFERENCES

Rivaj Maharaj (FASSA)

Lecturer, University of the Witwatersrand

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Rendani Mbuva

Associate Professor, Actuarial Science, University of the Witwatersrand

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